

The 6:15

SUNDAY · AUGUST 16, 2026

NO. 4

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS, WEEKEND-COMPRESSED

Tue 8/18	Alaska & Florida primaries — only elections in this window; Home Depot (HD) reports, cons. EPS \$4.69 / rev \$45.43B
Wed 8/19 → Tue 9/16	Lowe's (LOW), cons. EPS \$4.24 / rev \$26.2B — next FOMC decision 9/16

Nothing verified this run on OPEC+, lockups, or index-rebalance dates inside 8/17–8/26.

METRICS · AS OF FRI 8/14 CLOSE — MARKETS SHUT FOR THE WEEKEND, NEXT OPEN MON 8/17

Oil & rates	Brent \$88.52, +1.67% (ICE front) vs. \$87.47, +0.62% per Oilprice.com ; WTI \$82.40, +1.42%; UST 10Y 4.68–4.70%, 2Y 4.18%, 30Y 5.26%
Equities & other	S&P 7,785.76 (–0.17%, 3rd straight weekly gain); Nasdaq 26,729.16 (–0.28%); VIX 14.25; DXY 99.64; gold \$4,365–\$4,397/oz (trackers disagree) ; Nikkei 68,713.80 (+0.59%); Hang Seng 25,116.85 (–1.10%); FTSE 10,751.77 (–0.2%); DAX ~30,686 (+1.2%); gas \$4.0704/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/15)

No single Brent settle or gold spot confirmed this run — trackers diverge; ranges shown rather than one falsely precise figure.

HORMUZ COUNTERS · STRAITS.LIVE SNAPSHOT, 16 AUG 2026 1020Z UNLESS NOTED

Closure	Day 168
Transits vs. baseline	1 vessel on 8/9 (PortWatch, multi-day lag) vs. 73/day pre-crisis
Weekly transits	78 total, wk of 8/3–8/9, down from 95 the prior week; non-Iranian-linked 45, down from 63 (Lloyd's List, 8/12 brief) — first weekly decline since the late-July reopening push
Strikes	UAE/ADNOC: 2 tankers struck by drones night of 8/13, confirmed by UAE FM 8/14, no casualties, minor hull damage (UKMTO). CNBC (8/15) cites "another ship

being struck" — single-sourced, not confirmed this run. No confirmed running total since 8/1 found this run.

Dark tankers	58 AIS-dark in last 24h vs. 44.1 seven-day average
War-risk premia	30.0x pre-crisis, ~\$10.0M per VLCC passage (straits.live, unchanged since ≥8/11). Separately, Marsh/S&P Global peg cost at 7.5–10% of hull value — a different unit, not reconciled with the multiple above.

PortWatch/AIS lags days behind; Lloyd's List aggregates weekly commercial transits >10,000 dwt; straits.live blends broker war-risk quotes with dark-ship detection. Three separate universes — don't average or net them against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees / Knicks / Northwestern No reported roster moves in the last 24 hours

LEAD

HORMUZ • RHETORIC VS. REALITY

Trump says he'll make Hormuz “a territory of the United States” — Tehran calls it delusion, and says there's no negotiation to make it real anyway

Speaking Friday at a law-enforcement event in Garden City, New York, President Trump told the crowd that “after we finish defeating Iran, which is being very badly defeated, pretty soon I'll be declaring the Hormuz Strait a territory of the United States.” A White House official later told reporters the president was joking and that no formal policy process on any territorial claim exists. [fact: remarks and later clarification both confirmed] Iran did not treat it as a joke. Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi posted on X that “the Strait of Hormuz cannot be seized by tweet, nor by aircraft carrier, nor by issuing an order, nor by an election speech,” adding it “has been Iranian, is Iranian, and will remain Iranian.” Tehran's state media separately quoted Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi saying no

negotiations with the U.S. are underway at all right now. [fact: both quoted comments confirmed 8/15]

That last line is the one worth sitting with. Every issue since early August has carried the same throughline — Trump claims control, Iran calls it false, but a technical Oman-brokered shipping-lane framework was reportedly close to done underneath the noise. Araghchi's “no negotiations underway” is either a hardening of Iran's position, a bargaining posture, or simply refers to a narrower channel than the Oman framework — this run could not independently confirm which. [read] Either way, the gap between “close to a deal” reporting from early August and “no talks happening” now is itself the data point: whatever momentum existed toward reopening has stalled at the same moment the rhetoric on both sides has escalated from who controls it to who owns it.

The tape isn't panicking, but it isn't shrugging either. Brent settled Friday at \$88.52 (ICE front, Trading Economics), up 1.67% on the session and extending a multi-day climb; a second tracker (Oilprice.com) showed a smaller \$87.47 print, a divergence neither source resolves. **[no single settle confirmed]** The renewed attacks on shipping — UAE's ADNOC said two of its tankers were struck by drones transiting the strait the night of 8/13, confirmed by the UAE Foreign Ministry the next day with no casualties — are consistent with a market pricing continued disruption over any near-term reopening, and Lloyd's List's own transit count backs that reading: 78 vessels crossed in the week of 8/3–8/9, down from 95 the week before, the first weekly decline since the late-July reopening push that had briefly lifted traffic. [read: the “reopening momentum” story from two weeks ago has reversed]

Equities are telling a calmer, separate story. The S&P 500 closed Thursday at a fresh record — its 27th of 2026 — before slipping 0.17% Friday to 7,785.76, still a third straight weekly gain; the Nasdaq Composite eased 0.28% to 26,729.16. Neither move traces to Hormuz. Friday's dip followed a weaker-than-expected July retail sales report (Census: sales down 0.6% month-over-month to \$763.6B, dragged by a 1.8% drop in auto dealers and a 2.2% drop in nonstore/online retail), arriving two days after Wednesday's CPI print showed headline inflation cooling to 3.4% year-over-year and core to 2.5%, both down a tenth from June. [fact: both prints confirmed via BLS/Census]

The read-through is a Fed story, not a Hormuz story, and it's the same one that's been building all week: rate-hike odds for the September 16 FOMC meeting have been sliding since late July, when CME FedWatch trackers put a hike near two-in-three; a weak July jobs report cut that to roughly 44% by 8/7, and this week's soft CPI and softer retail sales pushed most trackers toward a 40%-hike/60%-hold split by Friday — the exact number varies by snapshot and source, but every reading available this run points the same direction, down. [read: the market is easing on rate-path relief even as it firms on oil-driven geopolitical risk — two separate repricings happening in the same tape, not one] That combination — cooling core inflation with an energy wildcard still live in Hormuz — is precisely the setup Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's July hawkish dot-plot shock was meant to guard against, and it's now his call whether one soft month changes that framing before Jackson Hole closes out the month.

POLITICS

The House and Senate are still working from two different government-funding bills, both of which would run past the current continuing resolution: the House passed its own version funding the government through December 4 in July; the Senate passed a separate bipartisan bill, 90-6, on Saturday 8/8, that would fund the government through December 11 and strips ICE/CBP funding already covered through the end of Trump's term plus a hold on a contested federal-grants rule. [DEVELOPING] Neither chamber has reconciled the two versions as of this run, and both are now out of session — the Senate until mid-September per its 8/8–8/9 recess vote — leaving the funding fight to resume, and needing resolution before the September 30 fiscal-year deadline, once both chambers are back. The only elections inside the next 10 days are the Alaska and Florida state primaries, both Tuesday 8/18; no federal races on that ballot affect control of either chamber before November.

TECHNOLOGY

Nvidia's six-firm, \$500 billion AI-infrastructure financing platform — with Apollo, BlackRock, Blackstone, Brookfield, Goldman Sachs and KKR — is now formally stood up as of its 8/10 announcement; CEO Jensen Huang told CNBC Nvidia itself could still back up to 25% of any single deal, and that he approached only these six firms, all of whom said yes. [established 8/10, no new deal terms confirmed this run] The mechanics matter more than the headline number: the structure keeps most of the debt for AI data centers off Nvidia's own balance sheet and instead treats compute infrastructure as an asset class managers can underwrite directly — closer to toll-road or real-estate financing than vendor credit. Watch for the first priced deal under the platform as the real test of whether private credit treats GPU-backed debt as investment-grade infrastructure or venture-style

risk. Separate reporting this week pointed to a heavy Q3 frontier-model release cadence across the major labs; **specific named/dated model releases circulating this week come from aggregator trackers rather than primary lab announcements and are not verified this run.**

GEOPOLITICS

Israeli airstrikes killed 11 people in southern Lebanon on Saturday, among the deadliest since the informal Israel-Hezbollah truce took hold — a reminder that the Hormuz standoff is one front in a wider regional conflict, not the whole of it. [NEW] In Yemen, Iran-backed Houthi forces hit the port of Mokha with more than 25 missiles over recent days, forcing it to suspend operations; local estimates put losses near \$16 million. **[single-sourced this run]** Both episodes sit alongside the UAE's account of the 8/13 drone strikes on its ADNOC tankers, which its Foreign Ministry called a “flagrant violation” of freedom-of-navigation norms — three separate incidents in three days across the same conflict system, none yet tied together in official statements but consistent with a general escalation rather than a de-escalation trend this week. No update this run on the Saudi-Pakistan-Turkey defense pact or the Khamenei command reshuffle covered in the prior issue; treating both as settled unless new action follows.

IRAN & HORMUZ

The transit data is the clearest signal that the “reopening momentum” narrative from two weeks ago has stalled: Lloyd's List counted 78 commercial transits in the week of 8/3–8/9, down from 95 the week before and the first weekly decline since traffic began recovering in late July, with non-Iranian-linked transits down to 45 from 63 over the same span. Dark-tanker activity moved the other way — 58 vessels ran AIS-dark in the 24 hours before this run's straits.live snapshot, well above the platform's own 44.1-vessel seven-day average — consistent with more operators choosing to move cargo

invisibly rather than accept war-risk pricing or transit risk openly. The war-risk premium itself hasn't moved: still 30x pre-crisis levels and roughly \$10 million to insure a single VLCC passage per straits.live, unchanged since at least 8/11, which tracks with Kpler's standing observation (carried in prior issues) that premiums jump fast on new attacks but decline only slowly through calm stretches — and this week didn't offer enough calm to test that. None of this bears directly on the Trump/Iran rhetorical exchange in the Lead; it's the slower-moving commercial track that will lag whatever happens politically by weeks either way.

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost to Blue Jays 4-1 Sat 8/15 in Toronto (McAdoo's 7th-inning RBI double the difference); 68-54, holding an AL wild-card spot behind Rays (74-47, AL East lead)
Knicks	Offseason; rookie Tyler Nickel added to the 2026-27 roster
Northwestern	Offseason; program announced a three-year, \$35M Uihlein family commitment 8/11; season opens 9/5 vs. South Dakota State

Continuity. Five-day gap since issue No. 3 (8/11) — this issue treats the intervening week (CPI, retail sales, CoreWeave/Cisco/Applied Materials earnings, Nvidia's financing platform launch) as resolved background folded into Lead/Technology rather than re-run as standalone Business/Economics sections, per the weekend-compression rule. Dropped as settled: Khamenei command reshuffle, Saudi-Pakistan-Turkey defense pact, six P&I clubs' war-risk withdrawal (last confirmed 8/11, not re-verified this run), the 30-year bond auction (settled 8/17). Updated, not dropped: the Oman shipping-lane framework — Araghchi's 8/15 "no negotiations underway" comment is a real change the next issue should track.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.